

# Estimator Aide: Evidence Brief

Representative pre-estimation artifact combining comparable Azure DevOps work with relevant code-analysis signals. The aide provides evidence and questions; Engineering remains responsible for technical approach and final estimation.

|                  |                                                                         |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Artifact         | Pre-estimation evidence brief                                           |
| Prepared by      | Nina Bernardo - Senior Business Analyst                                 |
| Input story      | Allow an authorized user to cancel an eligible booking before it starts |
| Evidence sources | Comparable ADO tickets + relevant code areas                            |
| Estimate         | Not assigned by the aide                                                |

**Purpose:** reduce the time spent starting estimation from a blank page. The output should make comparable historical work, likely technical touchpoints, uncertainty, and questions visible before sizing.

## 1. Functional scope summary

| Area                         | Current interpretation                                                                   | Confidence                    |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| User action                  | Authorized user cancels a booking in an eligible pre-start state.                        | High                          |
| State rule                   | In Progress / Completed are not cancellable through this feature.                        | High                          |
| Refund impact                | Existing refund handling remains unchanged.                                              | Medium - dependency to verify |
| Failure handling             | A failed update must not be shown as successful cancellation.                            | High                          |
| Potential regression surface | Booking status, cancellation workflow, notifications, payment/refund integration, tests. | Needs Engineering validation  |

## 2. Comparable Azure DevOps tickets

| Ref      | Why it looks comparable                                                 | What changed historically                                                         | Use with caution                                                    |
|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ADO-1842 | Changed validation around a booking-status transition.                  | API validation, UI error handling, automated tests.                               | Same domain does not mean same implementation path.                 |
| ADO-2317 | Modified an existing cancellation-like workflow.                        | Shared service logic, client state handling, regression updates in related flows. | Confirm whether the current story still uses the same shared logic. |
| ADO-2661 | Touched downstream notification behaviour after a booking-state change. | Event handling + notification template conditions.                                | Only relevant if cancellation emits the same event path.            |

## 3. Code-analysis signals

| Area                     | Signal surfaced                                                          | Why it may affect estimation                                                       | Confidence |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Booking UI               | Cancellation action appears conditional on booking state and permission. | May require UI state, confirmation, and failure feedback updates.                  | Medium     |
| Booking API              | Status transition validation appears centralized.                        | A shared validation path can widen regression scope beyond one screen.             | Medium     |
| Cancellation service     | Cancellation logic appears reused across more than one booking type.     | Changes may have cross-workflow impact.                                            | Low/Medium |
| Payment / refund service | Refund handling appears separately owned from booking cancellation.      | Story may depend on existing integration behaviour even if no refund rule changes. | Medium     |
| Tests                    | Historical work suggests both service and UI regression coverage.        | Testing effort may be broader than the visible requirement suggests.               | Medium     |

## 4. Complexity signals for refinement

| Signal                  | Evidence                                                                     | Question for Engineering                                                     |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Shared logic            | Historical ticket + code path suggest cancellation/validation may be reused. | Does this story change shared logic or only configuration/one path?          |
| Multiple layers         | Comparable work touched UI, API validation, service logic and tests.         | Which layers actually need modification for this story?                      |
| Downstream dependency   | Refund handling appears separately owned.                                    | Is cancellation already integrated with that service, or is new work needed? |
| Regression surface      | Related historical work required broader regression coverage.                | Which adjacent booking types / states need regression testing?               |
| Requirement uncertainty | Exact handling of a failed downstream update may affect technical design.    | Do we need retry, rollback, or user-visible recovery behaviour?              |

## 5. Evidence quality

| Evidence                | Quality                           | Why                                                                              |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ADO-1842                | Good comparison                   | Same status-validation area, but implementation still needs confirmation.        |
| ADO-2317                | Potentially strong                | Similar workflow and shared-service change; verify architecture has not changed. |
| ADO-2661                | Conditional                       | Useful only if the current change uses the same event/notification path.         |
| Code analysis           | Directional                       | Useful for likely touchpoints, not a substitute for engineer review.             |
| Historical story points | Not used as an automatic estimate | Past sizing is context-sensitive and should not be mechanically transferred.     |

## 6. Refinement handoff

| Bring into refinement                                                               | Do not present as fact                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Three comparable historical tickets with reasons they may or may not be relevant.   | That any historical ticket is an exact analogue.                 |
| Likely UI, API, service, downstream and test touchpoints.                           | That code-analysis signals equal confirmed implementation scope. |
| Questions around shared logic, refund integration, regression and failure handling. | A predetermined technical solution.                              |
| Evidence that may explain why the change is broader than the visible UI.            | An AI-generated story-point estimate.                            |

**Estimator Aide boundary:** this artifact intentionally stops before sizing. Engineering uses the evidence to validate scope, choose an implementation approach, and make the estimate.